Backup Caregiver Handover Kit

Everything a sibling, friend, neighbor or respite carer needs to step in while you are away

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

1. Fill it in a few days before you leave, while you can still check details with your loved one.
2. Copy medicine names and doses exactly from the pharmacy labels or the current medication list. Do not guess.
3. Walk through the Daily Routine page with the backup caregiver in person, if you can.
4. Leave the kit in one obvious place (kitchen counter or fridge). Add the date on every page you update.
5. Ask the backup caregiver to use the Daily Handover Log each day - it tells you what happened while you were away.
6. When you return, sit down for 10 minutes with the Return Debrief page and restock list.

THIS KIT COVERS

Care for: _____ Covering dates: _____

Backup caregiver: _____ Their phone: _____

Primary caregiver (me): _____ Where I can be reached: _____

PAGES IN THIS KIT

- ☐ About the person I care for
- ☐ Key contacts
- ☐ Daily routine timeline
- ☐ Medication schedule
- ☐ Meals & drinks
- ☐ Personal care & moving around
- ☐ House notes
- ☐ When to call for help
- ☐ Daily handover log (x2)
- ☐ Cover schedule (2 weeks)
- ☐ Return debrief & expenses

BEFORE I LEAVE

- ☐ Pill organizer filled for the whole time I'm away
- ☐ Prescriptions refilled
- ☐ Fridge & cupboards stocked
- ☐ Spare key given to backup caregiver
- ☐ Doctor's office told who is covering
- ☐ Backup caregiver has met my loved one
- ☐ Phone numbers saved in their phone
- ☐ Cash / card for small expenses left

This kit is an organizer, not medical advice. Follow the instructions of the person's doctors, nurses and pharmacist.

About the Person I Care For

The things a stranger would not know - fill in what matters

Name: _____ Likes to be called: _____

Date of birth: _____ Language(s): _____

Hearing: _____ Eyesight / glasses: _____

Walking aid: _____ Dentures / hearing aids: _____

ALLERGIES & THINGS TO AVOID

HEALTH CONDITIONS THE CARER SHOULD KNOW ABOUT

WHAT A GOOD DAY LOOKS LIKE

THINGS THAT COMFORT OR CALM THEM

THINGS THAT UPSET, WORRY OR CONFUSE THEM

FAVORITE TOPICS, MUSIC, TV, ACTIVITIES

Key Contacts

Call in this order unless it is an emergency - in an emergency call your local emergency number first

Who	Name	Phone	Notes / when to call
Emergency services	911 / 112 / local		
Primary caregiver (me)			
Backup family member			
Doctor / GP			
After-hours doctor line			
Pharmacy			
Home care agency / nurse			
Specialist			
Neighbor with a key			
Dentist / optician			
Taxi / transport			
Plumber / handyman			

Home address (to give in an emergency): _____

Daily Routine Timeline

Write the real order of the day - what happens, and how to help

Time	What happens	How to help / what they like
	Wake up	
	Bathroom / wash	
	Morning medicines	
	Breakfast	
	Morning activity	
	Snack & drink	
	Lunch	
	Midday medicines	
	Rest / nap	
	Afternoon activity	
	Dinner	
	Evening medicines	
	Evening wind-down	
	Bedtime	
	During the night	

Tip: routines matter more than clock times. If something is skipped, write it in the Daily Handover Log.

Medication Schedule

Copy exactly from pharmacy labels or the current list from the doctor. Never change doses.

Medicine name	Dose	When	With food?	What it's for	Where kept

Who sets up the pill organizer: _____ Refill due on: _____

Pharmacy phone: _____ Swallowing tips: _____

IF A DOSE IS MISSED OR REFUSED

Check with the pharmacist or doctor before giving a missed dose late or doubling up.

Meals & Drinks

Food is often the biggest source of stress for a new carer - be specific

Diet type: _____ Food texture: _____

Drinks per day (aim): _____ Favorite drink: _____

Eats at (place): _____ Needs help with: _____

Meal	Usually eats	Easy backup option
Breakfast		
Lunch		
Dinner		
Snacks		
Drinks		

LOVES

WON'T EAT / MUST AVOID

SHOPPING & WHERE FOOD IS KEPT

Personal Care & Moving Around

Tick the level of help needed and add how they like it done

Task	Alone	Watch	Some help	Full help	How they like it done
Getting out of bed					
Walking indoors					
Stairs / steps					
Getting in & out of a chair					
Toileting					
Washing / shower					
Dressing					
Teeth / dentures					
Hair / shaving					
Eating					
Going outside					

EQUIPMENT AND WHERE IT IS (WALKER, SHOWER CHAIR, GRAB BARS, PADS, WHEELCHAIR)

FALLS - WHAT TO DO IF THEY FALL

House Notes

The small practical things that save a dozen phone calls

Spare keys: _____

Alarm code - ask me directly _____

Wi-Fi name: _____

Thermostat / heating: _____

Trash & recycling day: _____

Mail / packages: _____

Water shut-off valve: _____

Fuse box / breaker: _____

Flashlight: _____

First aid kit: _____

Spare glasses / batteries: _____

Phone chargers: _____

TV / remote tips: _____

Pets & feeding: _____

Plants: _____

Car / parking: _____

REGULAR VISITORS, APPOINTMENTS AND DELIVERIES WHILE I'M AWAY

Day / date	Time	Who / what	Notes

HOUSE RULES / THINGS TO KNOW

When to Call for Help

Agree on these with the backup caregiver before you leave

CALL THE EMERGENCY NUMBER STRAIGHT AWAY FOR

- ☐ Trouble breathing or choking
- ☐ Chest pain or pressure
- ☐ Face drooping, arm weakness or slurred speech (signs of stroke)
- ☐ Not waking up or not responding normally
- ☐ A fall with a head injury, heavy bleeding or a possible broken bone
- ☐ Severe allergic reaction (swelling of face, lips or throat)

CALL THE DOCTOR / NURSE LINE FOR (FILL IN WITH THEIR ADVICE)

CALL ME (PRIMARY CAREGIVER) FOR

IF THEY GO TO HOSPITAL, TAKE

- ☐ This kit (medication page + contacts)
- ☐ Glasses, hearing aids, dentures
- ☐ Phone & charger
- ☐ ID & insurance / health card
- ☐ Walking aid
- ☐ A change of clothes

Preferred hospital: _____ **Legal papers kept at:** _____

Daily Handover Log

One box per day - a quick note for the next carer and for me

Date: _____ Carer: _____ Mood: ☐ good ☐ ok ☐ low

Medicines given (time) Morning Midday Evening Night

Meals eaten Breakfast Lunch Dinner Snacks

Drinks (cups) ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Toileting / bowels

Sleep / rest

Visitors / calls

Anything unusual

Note for next carer

Date: _____ Carer: _____ Mood: ☐ good ☐ ok ☐ low

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Meals eaten Breakfast Lunch Dinner Snacks

Drinks (cups) ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Toileting / bowels

Sleep / rest

Visitors / calls

Anything unusual

Note for next carer

Cover Schedule – 2 Weeks

Who is covering when, so nobody is left guessing

Week 1 starting: _____

Day	Morning	Afternoon	Evening / night	Notes
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Week 2 starting: _____

Day	Morning	Afternoon	Evening / night	Notes
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

BACK-UP PLAN IF SOMEONE CAN'T MAKE IT

Return Debrief & Expenses

10 minutes when you get back - what changed, what to restock, who to pay back

WHAT WENT WELL

WHAT WAS HARD / CHANGED

UPDATE THE KIT

- ☐ Medication list changed
- ☐ New contact added
- ☐ Routine changed
- ☐ Equipment needed
- ☐ Doctor follow-up booked
- ☐ Thank-you sent to helper

RESTOCK LIST

MONEY SPENT WHILE I WAS AWAY

Date	What for	Paid by	Amount	Paid back

Total: _____